

All figures sourced from Government of Canada and Government of Alberta open data, Statistics Canada, federal and provincial statute, UN treaty, and peer-reviewed research.

Movement Four — The Witness

The document closes here, in two sections. The first names what has been witnessed. The second names what the witnessing requires. The document then turns to the source index that supports every figure, every program reference, every legislative citation, every quoted source across the preceding 98 pages.

The closing is not a policy recommendation. It is not a call to action. It is not a summary of what has been said. The document has been written for readers who can construct their own response from the documentation. The closing is the document's recognition of the population the documentation is for, and of the structural reality that produces this document's existence.

Section 4.1 — What Has Been Witnessed

A document of this length, working this much primary-source material, accumulates an architecture of statistics. Each statistic represents a person. The closing returns to that.

The document has cited the figure 79,290 — the count of current AISH recipients in Alberta as of September 2025, the count facing the AISH-to-ADAP transition on July 1, 2026. The figure is published in Government of Alberta open data. The figure is also 79,290 individual people. Each one of them was an applicant once, gathered medical and financial documentation, completed the Part B Medical Report from a physician they may have struggled to find, liquidated retirement savings to clear the asset cap, waited the wait that may have lasted a year or more, and arrived at the program at the moment in their life when every other system had failed them. Each one of them, on July 1, 2026, will be moved to a program with reduced benefit, reduced rights, and no independent appeal — unless they actively apply, with fresh medical documentation, to remain on AISH through a Medical Review Panel they cannot guarantee will accept their application. Each one of them is a person. The figure is the count of those persons.

The document has cited the figure 16,161 — the count of Albertans on AISH receiving the federal CPP Disability benefit, whose contribution is captured dollar-for-dollar by the provincial offset. (*Source: Government of Alberta — AISH Caseload Open Data, September 2025.*) Each one of those 16,161 paid CPP through their working years on the assumption that the contribution was building toward a benefit they would receive when they needed it. Each one met the medical and contribution criteria for CPP-D — criteria that approximately 50–60 per cent of first-time applicants are denied under. Each one is now an AISH recipient receiving zero net benefit from the CPP-D contribution they made, because the provincial program structure is designed to capture the federal payment. Each one is a person. The figure is the count of those persons.

The document has cited the figure 19.07 — the gap, in years, between the average First Nations Albertan's life expectancy at birth in 2023 and the average non-First Nations Albertan's life expectancy at birth in 2023. (*Source: Alberta First Nations Information Governance Centre health statistics, 2023; Alberta Indigenous Primary Health Care Advisory Panel, 2022.*) The gap is the cumulative biological outcome of the conditions documented across the campaign's *Indigenous Disability in Alberta* report — the residential schools, the Indian Hospitals, the Sixties Scoop, the contaminated land, the unsafe water, the housing crisis, the healthcare racism, the jurisdictional fracture, the present-day federal and provincial policy choices that have not closed the gap and that continue, by Alberta Indigenous Watchdog's February 2025 documentation, to widen it. Each year of that 19.07-year gap represents people who did not live to access the senior

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architecture this document walks. Each life ended 2.19 years before the federal Old Age Security pension would have engaged. The senior architecture is, for the average First Nations Albertan, an architecture that does not arrive in time.

The document has cited the figure 6,000 to 8,000 — the count of Alberta seniors estimated by Public Interest Alberta to lose Alberta Seniors Benefit eligibility on July 1, 2026, when the provincial budget's 9 per cent threshold reduction takes effect. (*Source: Public Interest Alberta — Budget 2026 Analysis, March 2026; Red Deer Advocate, March 6, 2026.*) Each one of those 6,000 to 8,000 seniors is a person who, on July 1, 2026, will receive notice that the provincial supplement they received in May and June will not be paid in July. The same date is the AISH-to-ADAP transition. The two cuts are simultaneous. The provincial savings are projected at \$23 million in 2026-27 and \$31 million annually thereafter. The seniors absorbing the savings are 6,000 to 8,000 individual people who, in many cases, were already at the upper edge of the threshold and were already managing on the smallest of the partial benefit amounts.

The document has cited the figure 5,426 — the count of single parents on AISH in Alberta as of September 2025, almost entirely women, representing 6.8 per cent of the total caseload. (*Source: Government of Alberta — AISH Caseload Open Data, September 2025; Alberta Disability System Breakdown — AISH Evidentiary Report Series, April 2026, Section 9.1.*) Each one of those 5,426 single parents is a person navigating the cohabitation rule documented in Section 1.5, the housing-cost gap that exceeds the AISH benefit in private rental markets, the absence of accessible community housing for families with disabled children, the post-July-2026 ADAP framework that reduces partner-income exemptions and removes statutory indexing, and the daily reality of caregiving for children with disabilities while managing their own qualifying conditions. Each one is a person. The 5,426 is the count of those persons.

The document has cited multiple other figures — the \$873.54 monthly partnership penalty in GIS, the 650,000 Albertans without a family physician, the \$97 to \$130 billion annual value of unpaid Canadian caregiving labour, the 47 per cent of seniors with hearing loss, the 71 per cent of LGBTQ+ older adults concerned about access to future caregiving. Each figure represents people. The document's reliance on the figures is what the documentation requires. The documentation operates by accumulating the published evidence. The closing acknowledges that the figures are a count of people, and that the reality the figures describe is the daily life of those people.

Who has not survived to be documented

The Indigenous Disability in Alberta report's Section 2 establishes that the average First Nations Albertan, in 2023, did not live to age 65. The implication is direct: a substantial cohort of First Nations Albertans who would have been recipients of the federal-and-provincial senior architecture died before reaching it. The architecture has no record of them. They are not in any senior-program database. Their lifetime contributions of CPP, federal income tax, and provincial income tax produced no senior-stage benefit because there was no senior stage.

The cohort that does not appear in the senior-program statistics is the cohort whose absence is the most direct evidence of the architecture's failure for the Indigenous Albertan population. The 19.07-year mortality gap is what the cohort's absence looks like in numerical form. The names that do not appear in OAS, GIS, Alberta Seniors Benefit, Coverage for Seniors, and continuing-care databases are the names of people whose lives ended before those databases would have included them. The documentation can witness

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them only through the gap they left.

Beyond the Indigenous-specific cohort: the broader population of Canadians who fell through the gaps of the architecture before reaching the documentation is also not visible in current program statistics. The senior who died at 67 of an untreated condition because they could not afford the dental work that would have prevented the systemic infection. The senior whose hearing loss accelerated cognitive decline that produced the fall that produced the hospitalization that produced the long-term-care entry that produced the death three years before they would otherwise have died. The disabled adult who lost their primary caregiver and could not access the formal supports the architecture provides because the formal supports were not adequate to the actual care need. The 2SLGBTQ+ senior who avoided healthcare for fear of mistreatment until the avoided care became impossible to address. Each is a person. None is in any database that captures the cause-of-trajectory analysis the documentation is for.

The witnessing extends to them. The document cannot name them individually. The document acknowledges that they existed, that they passed through the architecture, and that their experience of the architecture is documented in the broader patterns the document has walked.

Who has been doing the work that produced this document

This document exists because of decades of advocacy, primary-source research, lived-experience documentation, and organizational labour by Canadians whose work has produced the source material the document compiles. The campaign that publishes this document — The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — is one element of a much broader advocacy and research community.

The advocacy organizations cited across the document — Inclusion Alberta, Inclusion Canada, the Council of Canadians with Disabilities, the Canadian Centre for Policy Alternatives, the Canadian Centre for Caregiving Excellence, Egale Canada, the Public Interest Alberta, the People's Alliance for Disabled Albertans, the Canadian Mental Health Association, the Canadian Association of Retired Persons, the National Institute on Ageing, the Institute for Research on Public Policy, the Caledon Institute of Social Policy, the Vanier Institute of the Family, the Canadian Coalition for Seniors' Mental Health, the Alberta Union of Provincial Employees, and others — have produced, across decades, the documentation that this document draws on.

The peer-reviewed researchers cited across the document have produced the academic literature that grounds the analysis in research evidence rather than in advocacy framing. The Statistics Canada and Government of Canada researchers and analysts cited have produced the published data that anchors every numerical claim. The Government of Alberta open-data publications cited have provided the provincial-level documentation. The journalists cited have produced the public-interest reporting that has, in many cases, been the first public surfacing of program changes that this document then documents in more depth.

The disability advocacy community in Alberta and in Canada has been doing the work this document compiles for decades. The senior-advocacy community has been doing the parallel work for decades. The Indigenous-led organizations have been doing the work this document's Indigenous-specific Section draws on for centuries, in some accountings. None of this document's analysis is original to the document. The document compiles, organizes, and presents. The work that produced the source material is the work of people whose names are in the source index that closes this document.

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The witnessing

The document has witnessed:

The cascade for the working-age person whose body fails, walked from the moment of the accident through the WCB system, through the AISH application, through the AISH-to-ADAP transition, through the cohabitation rule, to the bridge to age 65 (Movement One).

The federal-and-provincial architecture for the senior years, walked program by program, with the published math, the published thresholds, the published formulas (Movement Two).

The intersection populations — Indigenous seniors, 2SLGBTQ+ seniors, immigrant and racialized seniors, senior caregivers in three principal configurations — for whom the architecture operates with additional structural pressure (Movement Three).

Each Movement has been written in the same register. The register is clinical and sourced. The register is what the documentation requires. The register is also, in operational reality, the register the document's primary audiences need: the recipient navigating the architecture, the family member helping them, the policy professional whose work depends on accurate documentation, the journalist whose reporting depends on sourced material, the future government whose deliberation will benefit from a baseline analysis, the future researcher whose work will use this document as part of the historical record of the architecture as it operated in 2026.

The witnessing is what the document has done. The covenant — what the witnessing requires — is what Section 4.2 closes with.